

Think twice before choosing a window seat

Aisle or window? A common dilemma for travellers boarding long-haul flights. But research now confirms that aisle seats help prevent dangerous blood clots. A review of in-flight health risks published in the medical journal, *The Lancet* this month reports that you run a two-fold risk of developing dangerous blood clots (deep vein thrombosis) on flights lasting four hours or more if you occupy a window seat compared to an aisle or a middle seat. About 75 per cent of blood clots in the study occurred in

the lower limbs during long periods of immobility in cramped window seats. Clots can kill if they travel to the lungs. The absolute risk, however, remains a low 1 in 6,000. If you are obese, very tall or very short (taller than 1.9m or shorter than 1.6m) you are six times more likely to develop a blockage. By the way, business class makes no difference.



COUNT calories

Trying to lose weight? Say goodbye to those much-hyped eating plans, first. In a study reported in the latest *New England Journal of Medicine*, 800 overweight adults were put on popular diets—Atkins (low carb), Ornish (low-fat), Mediterranean (less animal protein)—cutting 750 calories from each a day. After two years, each group lost about the same weight regardless of the diet. The lesson? That people lose weight if they lower calories but it doesn't matter how.



Munch your way out of belly flab



AVOID AIR

A paunchy belly is often nothing but trapped wind. Eat slowly; avoid chewing gums.

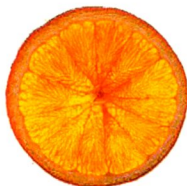


BREAD WOE

Go slow on bread. Some of the shelf-life expanding enzymes used are often not 'food'.

FIZZY LOGIC

Cut out fizzy drinks. Where do you think the bubbles go, even if you are drinking diet?



BLOAT FOOD

Citrus fruits, dry fruits, pulses or cabbage are likely to create wind in your gut. Avoid.

STRESS TALK

Your worst enemy. Stress hormone cortisol creates sugar craving and signals the body to store fat in the belly area.



MUFA POWER

Foods rich in monounsaturated fats—olive oil, nuts, seeds—shift toxic belly fat, free up internal organs and improve blood flow.



14%

OF WORKDAYS ARE
LOST BY INDIA INC
DUE TO EMPLOYEE
SICKNESS EVERY YEAR

NO TO JABS

Researchers at the Sree Chitra Tirunal Institute for Medical Science & Technology, Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala have come out with insulin pills coated with nanoparticles. New hope for diabetics controlling their sugar levels with those painful daily insulin jabs.

